

OWNED HERE

verification principle; meaning vs truth; cognitive significance; in-principle
 verifiability; Ayer's STRONG / WEAK senses; 1946 revision; Church 1949; pseudo-statement
 (Scheinsatz) and the two routes; das Nichts nichtet; the meaning-knowledge-ontology
 cascade; analytic/synthetic as EXHAUSTIVE; tautology; denial of the synthetic a priori;
 general statements, laws and theoretical terms; protocol sentences; tolerance and the
 internal/external distinction; emotivism as a COROLLARY; self-refutation

NOT OWNED - name in one clause, then stop

FALSIFIABILITY POPPER - DEMARCATION, not meaning; and he held
 metaphysics to be MEANINGFUL

TWO DOGMAS, HOLISM, ONTOLOGICAL

RELATIVITY TOPIC 11 Quine and Strawson

MEANING AS USE, LANGUAGE-GAMES,

PRIVATE LANGUAGE TOPIC 08 Later Wittgenstein

PICTURE THEORY, SAYING/SHOWING TOPIC 06 a SOURCE, not a version

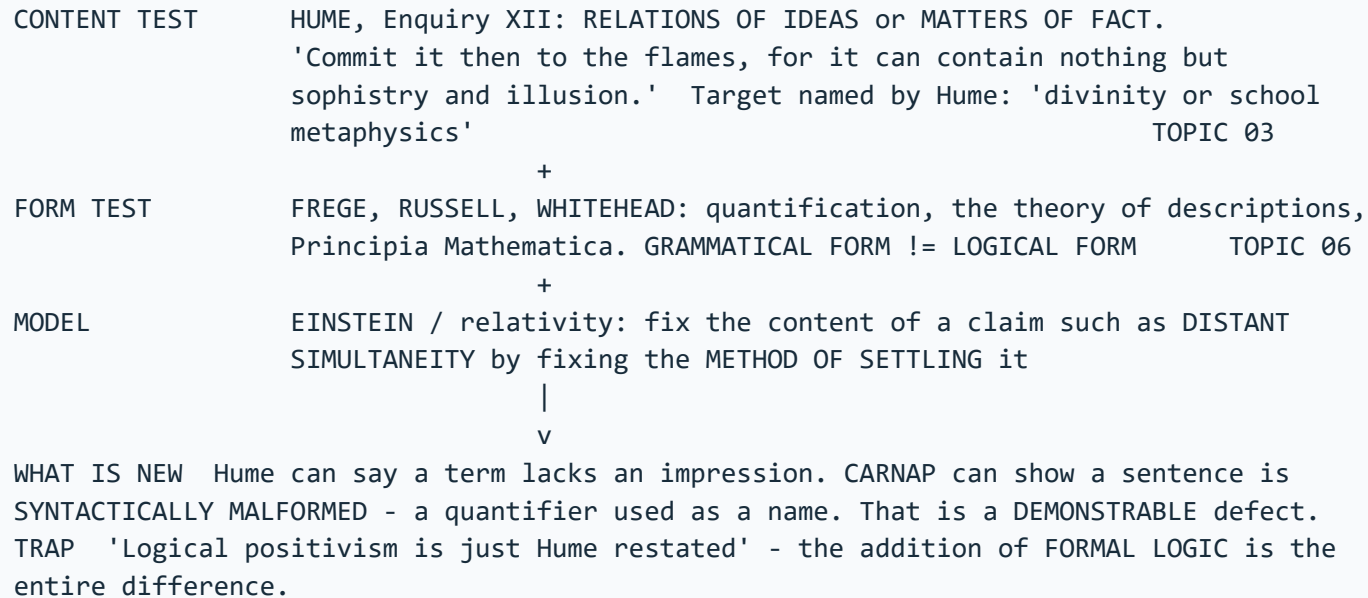
HUME'S OWN EPISTEMOLOGY TOPIC 03 Empiricism

KANT'S SYNTHETIC A PRIORI TOPIC 04 here only as the TARGET

ESCHATOLOGICAL VERIFICATION PAPER II Religious Language (Hick)

CORPUS SIGNAL 7 owned parts of 112 in 2018-2025. 2022 is the ONLY year without one.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/30: THE THREE INHERITANCES - AND WHAT WAS NEW IN 1929



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/30: CHRONOLOGY RAIL - THE MINIMUM THAT PREVENTS ANACHRONISM

1748 HUME, Enquiry XII - THE FORK
1921 Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung (German)
1922 Bilingual TRACTATUS LOGICO-PHILOSOPHICUS - NEVER date the English text 1921
1924- The Schlick Circle begins regular meetings in Vienna
1926-27 The Circle reads the Tractatus ALOUD, over more than a year
1929 MANIFESTO Wissenschaftliche Weltauffassung: Der Wiener Kreis
AUTHORS Hahn, Neurath, Carnap DEDICATED TO Schlick <-- collective document
1929 HEIDEGGER, Was ist Metaphysik? - 'das Nichts nichtet'
1929-32 Wittgenstein converses with SCHLICK and WAISMANN (McGuinness ed., 1979).
He was NEVER a member
1930 SCHLICK, 'The Turning Point in Philosophy'
1932 CARNAP, 'Überwindung der Metaphysik...' (Erkenntnis) - elimination of metaphysics
1932 NEURATH, 'Protokollsätze' (Erkenntnis) - THE BOAT
1932 SCHLICK, 'Positivism and Realism' - THE DIFFERENCE-ARGUMENT
1932 CARNAP, 'Über Protokollsätze' - the FORM of a protocol is a CHOICE
1932-33 AYER attends Circle meetings as a VISITOR
1934 SCHLICK, 'Über das Fundament der Erkenntnis' - AFFIRMATIONS
1934 CARNAP, Logische Syntax der Sprache (English 1937, s.17) - TOLERANCE
1934 POPPER, Logik der Forschung (English 1959) - FALSIFIABILITY as DEMARCATION.
Self-described 'official opposition'. NOT a member
1936 AYER, Language, Truth and Logic - the English transmission
1936 SCHLICK, 'Meaning and Verification' | QUINE, 'Truth by Convention'
1936 SCHLICK is MURDERED in Vienna; the Circle disperses; members emigrate
1937 STEVENSON, 'The Emotive Meaning of Ethical Terms' (Mind)
1944 STEVENSON, Ethics and Language
1946 AYER, LTL 2nd ed. - the REVISED criterion is in the INTRODUCTION
1949 CHURCH - the revised criterion ADMITS what it was designed to EXCLUDE
1950 CARNAP, 'Empiricism, Semantics, and Ontology' - INTERNAL / EXTERNAL
1951 QUINE, 'Two Dogmas of Empiricism' TOPIC 11
1953 WITTGENSTEIN, Philosophical Investigations, posthumous TOPIC 08
1960 QUINE, Word and Object - NEURATH'S BOAT as the EPIGRAPH
1960-65 GEACH sharpens the EMBEDDING problem against emotivism

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/30: THE VIENNA CIRCLE - MEMBERSHIP, MANIFESTO AND THE FENCE

INSIDE	TESTED ON
MORITZ SCHLICK 1882-1936	leader; difference-argument 1932; 'Turning Point' 1930; affirmations (Konstatierungen) 1934
RUDOLF CARNAP 1891-1970	elimination of metaphysics 1932; tolerance 1934/1937 s.17; internal/external 1950; the 1932 mediation
OTTO NEURATH 1882-1945	physicalism; revisable protocols 1932; THE BOAT; encyclopaedic unity of science
HANS HAHN 1879-1934	mathematician; co-author of the manifesto
FRIEDRICH WAISMANN 1896-1959	recorded the Wittgenstein conversations

OUTSIDE - AND WHY THE EXAMINER ASKS

A. J. AYER	visitor 1932-33; English statement 1936. NOT a member. STRONG/WEAK terminology is HIS
L. WITTGENSTEIN	read aloud 1926-27; conversations 1929-32. NEVER joined. The Tractatus is NOT a verificationist book
KARL POPPER	'official opposition'; falsifiability = SCIENTIFIC STATUS; held metaphysics MEANINGFUL
W. V. O. QUINE	admired Carnap, then attacked the two pillars from INSIDE empiricism

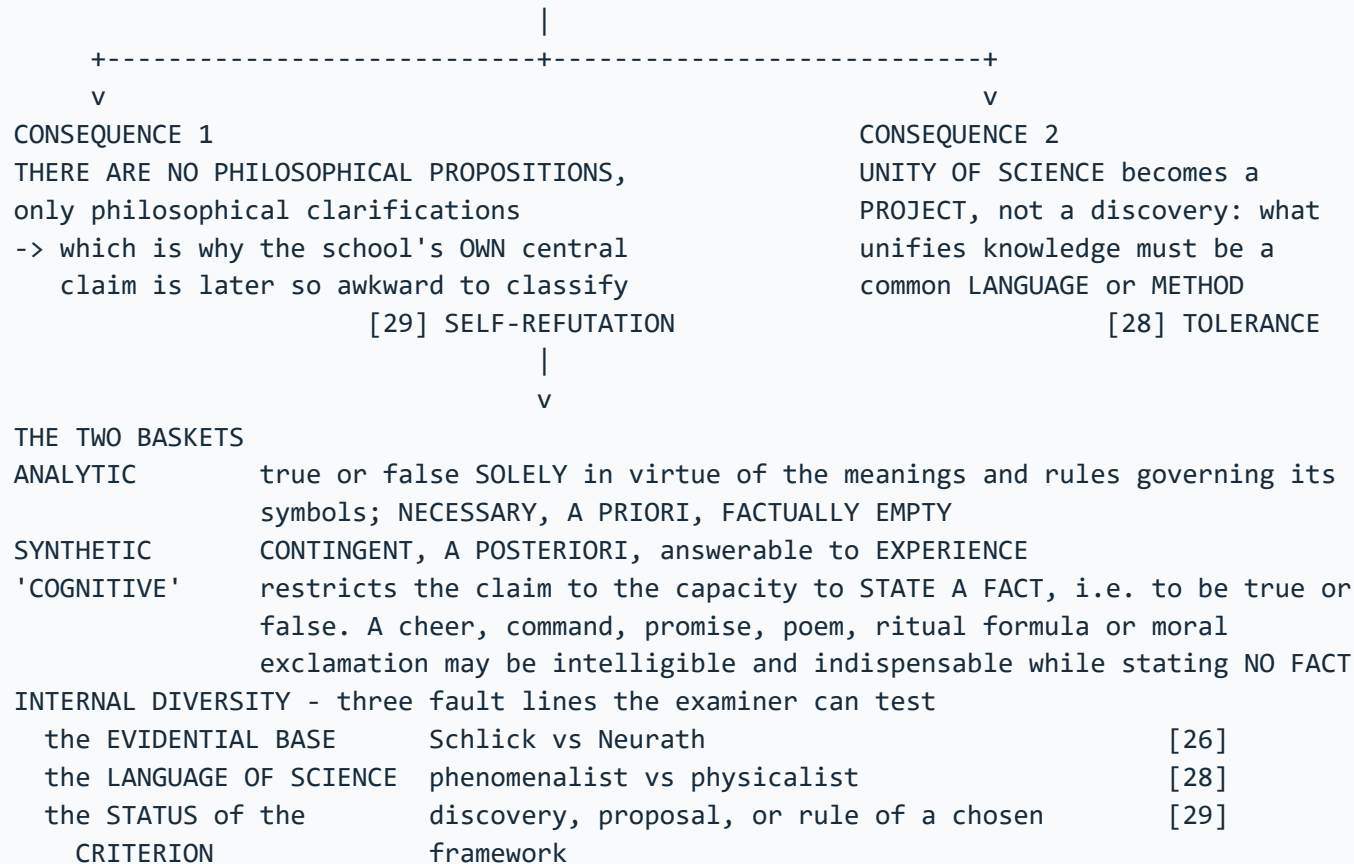
TOPIC 11

MANIFESTO EXACTLY Wissenschaftliche Weltauffassung: Der Wiener Kreis, 1929.

Authors HAHN, NEURATH, CARNAP. Dedicated to SCHLICK. A COLLECTIVE document.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/30: PHILOSOPHY REASSIGNED, AND THE TWO BASKETS

SCHLICK 1930 philosophy is NOT a system of propositions beside the sciences but an
ACTIVITY by which the MEANING of propositions is made clear



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/30: THE CRITERION - A TWO-KEY LOCK

COGNITIVELY MEANINGFUL = KEY 1 turns OR KEY 2 turns

KEY 1 ANALYTIC

wording true or false SOLELY in virtue of the meanings of its terms

yields necessity, apriority, certainty - and ZERO factual content

examples 'All bachelors are unmarried' | '2 + 2 = 4'

'All objects are either red or not red' <-- 2024 Q3(b)

KEY 2 EMPIRICALLY VERIFIABLE

STRONG conclusively verifiable by a FINITE set of observations

WEAK some possible observations are RELEVANT to its truth or falsehood -
would render it PROBABLE or IMPROBABLE

IN PRINCIPLE we can SPECIFY the observations even if no one can presently make them

examples 'This page is white' <-- 2024 Q3(b) | 'There are mountains on the far side
of the moon' | 'The earth is flat' (FALSE, therefore MEANINGFUL)

NEITHER KEY TURNS -> PSEUDO-STATEMENT (Scheinsatz)

'The Absolute is beyond time' | 'The nothing nothings' | 'The soul is immortal'

'The Good transcends Being' | 'The Soul of Superman is Good' <-- 2020 Q1(e)

VERDICT no truth-conditions, hence NO TRUTH-VALUE

THE BICONDITIONAL left-to-right it LICENSES science, logic and common sense;

right-to-left it EXCLUDES everything else. An 'exposition' must give BOTH halves.

SENTENCE	MEANING	TRUTH
'The earth is flat'	MEANINGFUL	FALSE
'Mountains on the far side of the moon'	MEANINGFUL in 1935	later established TRUE
'This page is white'	MEANINGFUL	true or false by inspection
'All objects are either red or not red'	MEANINGFUL	TRUE, and factually EMPTY
'The Absolute is beyond time'	NOT MEANINGFUL	NO TRUTH-VALUE ASSIGNED

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CONSEQUENCE THAT CARRIES THE 2023 ANSWER

Because the metaphysical sentence receives NO TRUTH-VALUE, the positivist is NOT saying 'the Absolute does not exist'. That would be a MEANINGFUL DENIAL requiring the very truth-conditions he says are missing. The rejection is at the level of the SENTENCE, not of the OBJECT.

MEMORY FALSE = the world said no. MEANINGLESS = the world was never asked.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/30: IN PRINCIPLE vs IN PRACTICE; WHAT 'COGNITIVE' EXCLUDES

IN PRINCIPLE we can SPECIFY the observations that would settle it -> MEANING

IN PRACTICE present technology, funding, location -> IRRELEVANT

'Mountains on the far side of the moon' (1935): meaningful. 'The Absolute is beyond all experience': fails EVEN IN PRINCIPLE, because the sentence itself forbids specification.

THE VERDICT DOES NOT ASSERT

NOT that the words are UNINTELLIGIBLE

NOT that the utterance is WORTHLESS

NOT that expressive, ritual, practical or poetic USES are abolished

NOT that the speaker is insincere or confused as a person

IT ASSERTS ONLY that the sentence does not STATE A FACT.

LABELS AND THEIR FORCE

pseudo-statement (Scheinsatz) grammatical form of a statement, no logical function

cognitively meaningless no truth-conditions, hence no truth-value

'false' WRONG - falsity presupposes truth-conditions

'unprovable' WRONG - this concedes it is a proposition

'nonsense' unqualified RISKY - invites the ordinary-language reading

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/30: THE STRONG SENSE AND ITS CASUALTIES

STRONG a statement is verifiable iff its truth can be CONCLUSIVELY ESTABLISHED with certainty by a FINITE set of observations. Both words are load-bearing.

ADVANTAGE rigorous; excludes metaphysics cleanly

CASUALTIES

UNIVERSAL LAWS 'All metals expand when heated' - indefinitely many instances; no finite set exhausts them

THE PAST 'Caesar crossed the Rubicon' - not now observable

OTHER MINDS 'She is in pain' - another's experience is not my observation

SURVIVES singular present-tense observation reports: 'this page is white'

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VERDICT STRONG VERIFICATION KILLS SCIENCE. A criterion of meaning that convicts the sentences of physics is self-evidently the wrong criterion, and Ayer says so.

TRAP naming only universal laws gives ONE THIRD of the casualty list and weakens the dilemma the answer is trying to establish.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/30: THE WEAK SENSE AND ITS COST

WEAK a statement is verifiable iff some possible observations are RELEVANT to its truth or falsehood - would render it PROBABLE or IMPROBABLE.

ADVANTAGE saves scientific generalisations and statements about the past and the future

COST RELEVANCE IS CHEAP. Conjoin the metaphysical sentence with an AUXILIARY HYPOTHESIS and an observation-statement follows from the PAIR that does not follow from the auxiliary ALONE -> metaphysics creeps back in

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THE FORK, STATED ONCE

Tight enough to exclude metaphysics is tight enough to exclude physics.

Loose enough to admit physics is loose enough to admit metaphysics.

NO SETTING OF THE DIAL DOES BOTH JOBS.

THIS IS THE PRINCIPLE'S INTERNAL PROBLEM. It needs no external critic and is DISTINCT from the self-refutation objection at [29]. Keeping them apart is itself a mark.

ATTRIBUTION FENCE STRONG/WEAK is AYER'S vocabulary. Do NOT write 'the Vienna Circle distinguished strong and weak verification' as one agreed Circle doctrine.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/30: THE REPAIR AND ITS FAILURE - THREE DATES, NEVER MERGED

1936 LTL 1st ed. WEAK test: observations that make the proposition PROBABLE

1946 LTL 2nd ed. the INTRODUCTION supplies a technical replacement:

DIRECTLY VERIFIABLE it is itself an observation-statement, OR with one or more
observation-statements it entails an observation-statement
NOT deducible from those premisses alone

INDIRECTLY VERIFIABLE with further premisses it entails a DIRECTLY verifiable
statement not deducible from those premisses alone, AND
those premisses are analytic, or directly verifiable, or
independently shown to be indirectly verifiable

1949 CHURCH the revised criterion ADMITS statements it was designed to EXCLUDE:
given three mutually independent observation-statements, an
ARBITRARY sentence can be shown to satisfy the conditions

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MIGRATION VERIFICATION -> CONFIRMATION and TESTABILITY of SYSTEMS

GAIN a far better account of how evidence supports scientific theory

LOSS the sharp, sentence-by-sentence boundary between meaningful and meaningless

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/30: THE POSITIVE CASE - FIVE MOTIVATIONS, GRADED

- 1 DIFFERENCE-ARGUMENT Schlick, 'Positivism and Realism', 1932. STRONGEST
If two hypotheses agree on EVERY possible observation they do not differ in CONTENT -
they are ONE hypothesis in TWO VOCABULARIES. A principle of SIGNIFICANCE, not of
epistemology. It SURVIVES the collapse of the criterion as a weaker heuristic.
 - 2 THE EINSTEIN MODEL relativity forces operational attention to how claims such as
DISTANT SIMULTANEITY are fixed and tested. STRONG INFLUENCE
LIMIT not a proof that every concept reduces to ONE measurement procedure
 - 3 MEANING AND USE-CONDITIONS understanding a factual sentence includes knowing the
circumstances relevant to asserting and testing it. QUALIFIED
CAUTION do NOT import later meaning-as-use. The Circle builds ONE UNIFORM empiricist
test; later Wittgenstein refuses uniformity itself TOPIC 08
 - 4 THE DEMARCATION MOTIVE a PUBLIC criterion separating empirical science from
metaphysics. CONTESTED
POPPER'S RIVAL falsifiability = SCIENTIFIC STATUS, not meaning; metaphysics remains
MEANINGFUL. DIFFERENT QUESTION, not a repair
 - 5 UNITY OF SCIENCE phenomenalist reduction, later physicalist public-language projects,
seeking intertranslation or coordination. INTERNALLY DISPUTED [28]
- ANSWER-CRAFT open a 'discuss verification' answer HERE, not with self-refutation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/30: THE ARGUMENT IN SIX STEPS

- 1 To UNDERSTAND a sentence is to know what it would be for it to be TRUE
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- 2 To know that is to DISTINGUISH the circumstances in which it holds from those in which it does not
|
- 3 To distinguish those circumstances is to know what would count as EVIDENCE either way
|
- 4 ∴ UNDERSTANDING a sentence = GRASPING ITS VERIFICATION-CONDITIONS
|
- 5 ∴ a sentence for which NO evidence could count either way has NOTHING for understanding to consist in
|
- 6 ∴ such a sentence is NOT FALSE; it is WITHOUT COGNITIVE CONTENT

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 15/30: THE FOUR PRESUPPOSITIONS - AND THE OBJECTION MAP THEY GENERATE

- P1 Understanding is exhausted by TRUTH-CONDITIONS, and truth-conditions are exhausted by OBSERVATION-CONDITIONS
<- the identification is made at step 2->3 and is NEVER ARGUED FOR
- P2 OBSERVATION-STATEMENTS ARE EPISTEMICALLY PRIVILEGED - there is a level of report not itself theory-laden
<- attacked FROM WITHIN by the PROTOCOL DEBATE [26]
- P3 Sentences face experience INDIVIDUALLY
<- Duhem-Quine HOLISM: tests implicate auxiliaries and whole networks TOPIC 11
<- and STRAINED ALREADY by the positivists' own theory-network account [25]
- P4 The ANALYTIC/SYNTHETIC distinction is SHARP - the criterion's FIRST DISJUNCT depends on it
<- 'Two Dogmas' 1951 attacks the boundary rather than settling it TOPIC 11
- WHY THIS PANEL IS WORTH TWENTY-MARK SPACE
It converts an unordered list of objections into a STRUCTURE: each major criticism is the DENIAL OF ONE HINGE, and the script can say WHICH HINGE and WHY.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 16/30: THE TRACTATUS LEDGER - TAKEN, ADDED, AND THREE FENCES

TAKEN		ADDED BY THE CIRCLE
SENSE = TRUTH-CONDITIONS (4.022, 4.024)		MEANING = VERIFICATION-CONDITIONS
BIPOLARITY is a LOGICAL requirement:		VERIFIABILITY is an EPISTEMIC requirement:
a determinate place in logical space		SOMEONE must be able to check
metaphysics is NONSENSICAL (unsinnig)		metaphysics is MEANINGLESS because NO
because it fails to DEPICT		OBSERVATION IS RELEVANT
the base is OBJECTS never exemplified -		the base is OBSERVATIONS / PROTOCOLS -
a LOGICAL POSTULATE		an EMPIRICAL claim -> hence [26]
value / the mystical MANIFEST but are		AYER gives value utterances an EMOTIVE role -
not factual propositions		an ADDED metaethical theory [21]
ALSO TAKEN the boundary project; logic as TAUTOLOGY; philosophy as an ACTIVITY; the exposure of surface grammar		

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THE CONSEQUENCE THAT MATTERS

Universal laws have SPECIFIABLE truth-conditions but NO conclusive verification-conditions -> the substitution ITSELF generates the strong/weak dilemma [10][11]

THREE FENCES

- (i) Wittgenstein was NEVER A MEMBER of the Vienna Circle
- (ii) the TRACTATUS IS NOT A VERIFICATIONIST TEXT - the substitution is the CIRCLE'S OWN
- (iii) LATER Wittgenstein endorses NO single criterion of meaning at all TOPIC 08

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 17/30: REJECTION OF METAPHYSICS - THE IDENTIFICATION PROCEDURE

STEP 1 Is the sentence ANALYTIC - true or false by meanings and rules alone?
YES -> MEANINGFUL and factually EMPTY. STOP
NO -> Step 2

STEP 2 Can ANY possible observation count FOR or AGAINST it (in principle)?
YES -> MEANINGFUL, synthetic. STOP
NO -> Step 3

STEP 3 DIAGNOSE the failure - WHICH ROUTE?
ROUTE 1 a constituent TERM has NO EMPIRICAL CRITERION OF APPLICATION
ROUTE 2 individually significant terms are COMBINED so that NO
TRUTH-CONDITIONS RESULT

STEP 4 VERDICT PSEUDO-STATEMENT (Scheinsatz).
Record what is NOT claimed: not false; not unproven; not unintelligible;
expressive and practical force untouched

SOURCE CARNAP, 'Überwindung der Metaphysik durch logische Analyse der Sprache',
Erkenntnis, 1932. AYER: a metaphysical sentence 'purports to express a genuine
proposition, but does not.'

2021 Q2(b) ASKS FOR THIS PROCEDURE, not for a list of condemned sentences.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 18/30: THE TWO ROUTES, WORKED - FOUR GRADED EXAMPLES AND TWO CONTROLS

'The soul is immortal'	ROUTE 1 no empirical criterion for 'soul'
'The Good transcends Being'	ROUTE 1 + ROUTE 2 neither term has a criterion, and the relation yields no truth-conditions
'Caesar is a prime number'	ROUTE 2 grammatical, every word significant, NO verification procedure applies
'The nothing nothings'	ROUTE 2 - THE PARADIGM [19]

CONTROLS - INCLUDE ONE, OR THE TEST LOOKS LIKE A BLACKLIST

'Electrons have negative charge'	MEANINGFUL - empirically testable, though INDIRECTLY, through a predictive theoretical network [25]
'2 + 2 = 4'	MEANINGFUL - analytic, true by the rules of arithmetic, factually EMPTY [23]

WHY BOTH ROUTES ARE NEEDED route 1 alone cannot handle 'Caesar is a prime number';
route 2 alone cannot handle 'the soul is immortal'.

SOURCE HEIDEGGER, Was ist Metaphysik?, 1929: 'Das Nichts nichtet'

ANALYSIS CARNAP, Erkenntnis, 1932 - a DOUBLE violation:
 (a) 'nothing' is a LOGICAL QUANTIFIER used as if it NAMED something
 (b) 'nothings' is a PSEUDO-VERB predicated of that pseudo-name
The sentence is PARASITIC on the form 'Something does X'. The defect is in
LOGICAL SYNTAX, not in ordinary grammar, and is therefore DEMONSTRABLE

RENDERING CORRECT: 'Nothing noths' or 'the nothing nothings'
FORBIDDEN: 'Nothing noughts' is NOT a rendering of this phrase and must
NEVER be written

HEIDEGGER'S AVAILABLE REPLY - report it, or the answer is ridicule rather than assessment
'Das Nichts' is disclosed in the mood of ANXIETY (Angst), and the breach of
logical grammar is DELIBERATE, since LOGIC ITSELF PRESUPPOSES the prior
disclosure of beings as a whole see TOPIC 10

ATTRIBUTION the sentence is HEIDEGGER'S; the ANALYSIS is CARNAP'S. Never merge them.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 20/30: THE CASCADE - MEANING, KNOWLEDGE, NATURE OF THINGS

LEVEL	WHAT THE POSITIVIST SAYS	WHAT HE MAY NOT SAY
MEANING	the sentence has NO truth-	--
(the ROOT)	conditions; PSEUDO-STATEMENT	
KNOWLEDGE	the question is DISSOLVED, not answered: one can neither know nor fail to know what is not a proposition	that we are IGNORANT of metaphysical truths (agnosticism presupposes a proposition whose truth-value is undetermined)
NATURE OF THINGS	the QUESTION of existence is ILL-FORMED	that the Absolute, the soul or God DOES NOT EXIST - a denial needs the very truth-conditions declared absent

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THE CONNECTION meaning grounds knowledge; knowledge grounds claims about the world. Cutting at the level of MEANING simultaneously eliminates PSEUDO-KNOWLEDGE and PSEUDO-ONTOLOGY.
2023 Q3(a) VERDICT ALL THREE, THROUGH MEANING AS THE ROOT.
Saying 'all of them together' WITHOUT the ordering describes the question instead of answering it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 21/30: ETHICS AND AESTHETICS - AYER AGAINST STEVENSON

WHY ETHICS IS HERE AT ALL (i) Ayer APPLIES the criterion to value language, so emotivism is a COROLLARY of the verification principle; (ii) 2020 Q1(e) asks about 'Good'

	AYER LTL 1936, ch. 6	STEVENSON Mind 1937; Ethics and Language 1944
WHAT THE TERM DOES	PURE EXPRESSION: adding '...is wrong' adds NO factual content; it EVINCES and may EVOKE	TWO meanings: a DESCRIPTIVE meaning varying with context AND an EMOTIVE meaning - a disposition built by usage to express and evoke attitude
A REPORT OF FEELING?	NO - BOTH reject SUBJECTIVISM, and for the SAME reason: it turns moral disagreement into disagreement about AUTOBIOGRAPHY. BOTH ARE NON-COGNITIVISTS, NOT SUBJECTIVISTS	
MODEL OF 'X IS GOOD'	(no propositional paraphrase at all)	'I approve of X; DO SO AS WELL' - expression PLUS imperative element
DISAGREEMENT	always REALLY ABOUT FACTS; once facts are agreed 'we should not attempt to argue'	DISAGREEMENT IN BELIEF vs DISAGREEMENT IN ATTITUDE - the latter CAN SURVIVE complete factual agreement
IS ARGUMENT POSSIBLE?	essentially NO	YES - reasons work CAUSALLY by altering the beliefs on which attitudes rest; RATIONAL vs PERSUASIVE methods
FURTHER DOCTRINE	derived TOP-DOWN from the theory of meaning	PERSUASIVE DEFINITION - 'REAL democracy is...'. Built BOTTOM-UP and INDEPENDENT of the criterion
VERDICT	Ayer's emotivism is a DEDUCTION from the criterion and shares its fate; Stevenson's is an INDEPENDENT theory of linguistic influence which explains what Ayer could not - how moral argument can be genuine though moral judgements state no fact.	

FREGE-GEACH EMBEDDING PROBLEM (Geach 1960, 1965; anticipated by Frege)

'If lying is wrong, then getting your brother to lie is wrong.' The ANTECEDENT is UNASSERTED and expresses NO attitude, yet it must mean the SAME as the free-standing 'lying is wrong' for the modus ponens to be valid.

FORCE DECISIVE against simple emotivism. REPLY later expressivists (Blackburn, Gibbard) construct logics of attitude; NEITHER Ayer NOR Stevenson had an answer

OTHER OBJECTIONS moral disapproval vs mere distaste (Stevenson can appeal to GENERALITY and SOCIAL function; AYER CANNOT) | moral progress (Stevenson: convergence of attitude under fuller belief; AYER concedes)

THEOLOGY AT OWNED DEPTH

transcendent existence-claims fail the criterion by ROUTE 1

NOT ATHEISM - atheism is a MEANINGFUL DENIAL; the positivist declines the question ritual, expressive, communal and practical uses are a SEPARATE question

HICK'S ESCHATOLOGICAL VERIFICATION - one clause only PAPER II

2020 Q1(e) 'THE SOUL OF SUPERMAN IS GOOD' - THE SPLIT IS THE MARKS

SUBJECT 'the Soul of Superman' - no empirical criterion of application; fictional bearer ROUTE 1 [18]

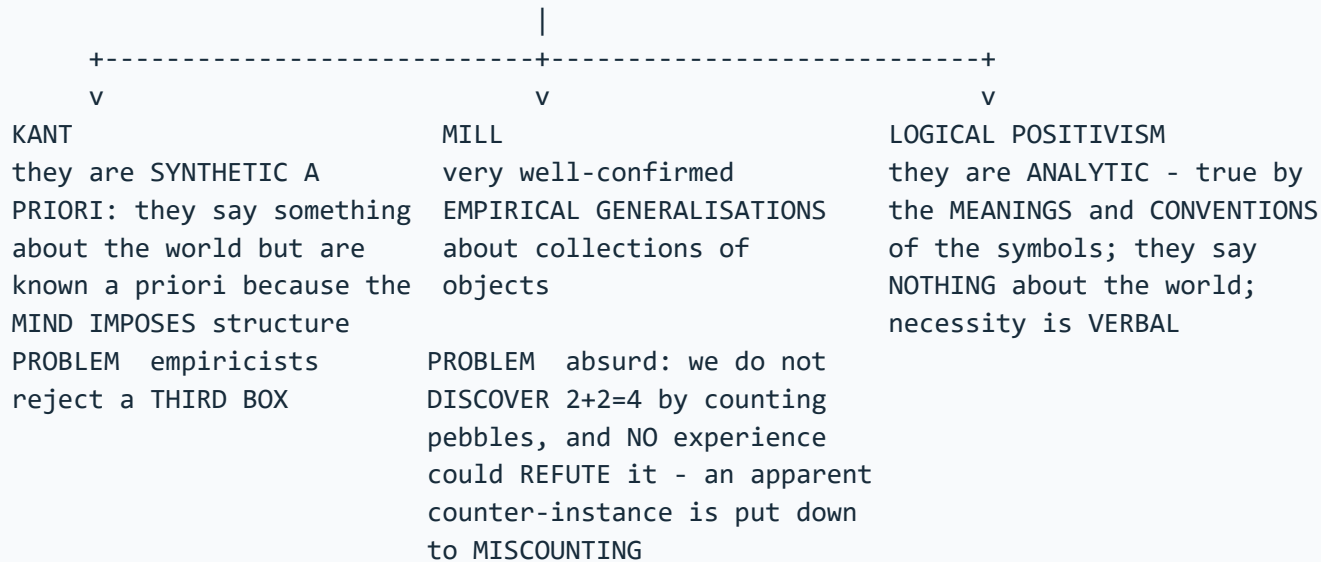
PREDICATE 'is Good' - adds NO factual content; EVINCES approval EMOTIVE [21]

WHOLE neither analytic nor empirically verifiable -> COGNITIVELY MEANINGLESS, NOT FALSE

QUALIFY within an explicitly stated FICTION-FRAMEWORK, 'in the story, Superman is portrayed as good' IS checkable. Do NOT claim every fictional or ethical sentence is meaningless in every use

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 23/30: LINGUISTIC THEORY OF NECESSITY - TRILEMMA AND THREE RIVALS

THE TRILEMMA logic and mathematics are NECESSARY + A PRIORI + CERTAIN, yet empiricism says ALL KNOWLEDGE COMES FROM EXPERIENCE



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HOW THE POSITIVIST ACCOUNT DELIVERS ALL FOUR FEATURES FROM ONE SOURCE

NECESSARY their truth follows from the rules laid down for the symbols; no experience could refute them BECAUSE THEY SAY NOTHING EXPERIENCE COULD BEAR ON

A PRIORI grasping the meanings SUFFICES; no observation needed

CERTAIN to deny them is to VIOLATE ONE'S OWN CONVENTIONS - self-contradiction

EMPTY 'All bachelors are unmarried' records our RESOLVE to use two expressions interchangeably <-- THE PRICE, AND THE POINT

MEMORY a necessary proposition is CERTAIN because it FORBIDS NOTHING.

ANALYTIC		SYNTHETIC
necessary - a priori - EMPTY of		contingent - a posteriori - FACTUAL - fallible
content - certain		
logic - mathematics - definitions		empirical science - history - common sense
THERE IS NO THIRD BOX -> the SYNTHETIC A PRIORI is declared INCOHERENT; Kant's central innovation is DISSOLVED. Kant appears HERE ONLY AS THE TARGET		
		TOPIC 04

2024 Q3(b), WORKED

'All objects are either red or not red'	ANALYTIC / TAUTOLOGY, form $P \vee \sim P$. MEANINGFUL as a LOGICAL truth: true under all truth-conditions; says NOTHING about the world; NO observation could refute it BECAUSE IT IS EMPTY. Truth depends only on 'or' and 'not'
'This page is white'	SYNTHETIC / EMPIRICAL. MEANINGFUL because VERIFIABLE: look at the page. Depends on an OBSERVABLE FACT, and it COULD BE FALSE (the page might be blue)

ANSWER AS ASKED NO. Both meaningful, by DIFFERENT BRANCHES. Metaphysics fits NEITHER.

PRESSURES - name at least one, or the answer describes rather than elucidates

QUINE 'Truth by Convention' 1936 conventions must be APPLIED, and deriving their infinitely many consequences ALREADY PRESUPPOSES LOGIC -> circularity TOPIC 11

QUINE 'Two Dogmas' 1951 analyticity cannot be NON-CIRCULARLY DEFINED

APPLICABILITY if mathematics is empty, why is it INDISPENSABLE in physics? Reply: applicability belongs to the EMBEDDING EMPIRICAL THEORY

GODEL limitative results constrain PARTICULAR formal systems; NOT a one-line refutation of every conventionalist account - do not overreach

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 25/30: GENERAL STATEMENTS, FOUR HARD CASES, AND CONFIRMATION

- 1 UNIVERSAL LAWS 'All metals expand when heated'
DIFFICULTY indefinitely many instances; strong verification fails
ROUTE LAW + INITIAL CONDITIONS + AUXILIARIES -> PREDICTION -> OBSERVATION REPORT
-> the SYSTEM is confirmed or strained
COST support is NEVER proof; failure never points at ONE sentence -> P3 [15]
- 2 THE PAST 'Caesar crossed the Rubicon'
ROUTE present RECORDS, TRACES and TESTIMONY, read through causal/historical theory
COST a strict phenomenalist reduction CONFUSES the EVIDENCE for the claim with
its PAST-DIRECTED CONTENT - the sentence is about Caesar, not the parchment
- 3 OTHER MINDS 'She is in pain'
ROUTE publicly observable BEHAVIOUR, LANGUAGE and explanatory THEORY
COST reducing pain SIMPLY to behaviour is ONE behaviourist route, NOT forced
- 4 THEORETICAL ENTITIES 'Electrons have negative charge'
ROUTE significance through the term's ROLE in laws, auxiliaries and the testable
consequences of a THEORY-NETWORK
COST network content means meaning is NOT assigned SENTENCE BY SENTENCE - and
the criterion WAS a sentence-by-sentence criterion

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WHY METAPHYSICAL UNIVERSALS ARE STILL EXCLUDED

2019 Q2(a)

'All reality is spiritual' generates NO prediction under ANY initial conditions and ANY auxiliaries. Scientific universals have SYSTEMATIC EMPIRICAL CONSEQUENCES; metaphysical universals specify NO COMPARABLE TEST. The difference is CATEGORICAL, not of degree. COUNTER-PRESSURE, conceded weakening verification DOES risk admitting metaphysics; the reply is that PUBLIC PREDICTIVE INTEGRATION differs from insulation from evidence, since scientific auxiliaries are themselves independently testable. The boundary REMAINS CONTESTED.

2018 Q3(b) VERDICT NOT on the strong sense; on the weak sense ONLY AT THE COST OF THE SHARP BOUNDARY.

FENCE potential FALSIFICATION is POPPER'S DEMARCATION proposal, NOT Ayer's definition of meaning.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 26/30: THE PROTOCOL-SENTENCE DEBATE - THE CRISIS INSIDE, 1932-35

THE QUESTION what is the FORM and STATUS of Protokollsätze - the observation-statements in which verification TERMINATES? INCORRIGIBLE FOUNDATIONS or ORDINARY REVISABLE SENTENCES?

	SCHLICK 1934		NEURATH 1932
	'Über das Fundament der Erkenntnis'		'Protokollsätze'
POSITION	FOUNDATIONALISM		COHERENTISM + PHYSICALISM
THE BASE	Konstatierungen - AFFIRMATIONS of the form 'HERE NOW BLUE'		PHYSICALIST, fully explicit protocols INCLUDING the observer and the TIME
STATUS	ABSOLUTELY CERTAIN: understanding the sentence and VERIFYING it are ONE AND THE SAME ACT - no gap for error to enter		FALLIBLE and REVISABLE like any other sentence. NOTHING is sacrosanct; even a protocol may be STRUCK OUT if it conflicts with the rest of the system
REALITY	the 'UNSHAKEABLE POINT OF CONTACT' between the system of knowledge and reality		'STATEMENTS ARE COMPARED WITH STATEMENTS, NOT WITH "EXPERIENCES".'
			NO EXIT from language to an unmediated given
THE CATCH	an affirmation CANNOT BE WRITTEN DOWN AND PRESERVED: recording it yields a HYPOTHESIS about a PAST MOMENT. Certainty is MOMENTARY and UNUSABLE		consistency with the accepted system is the ONLY test; conflicting protocols are decided by the WORKING PRACTICE of the scientific community
IMAGE	knowledge as a structure needing a FIXED GROUND		THE BOAT: 'We are like sailors who have to rebuild their ship on the open sea, without ever being able to dismantle it in dry-dock and reconstruct it from the best components.'

CARNAP'S MEDIATION 'Uber Protokollsätze', 1932: the FORM of protocol sentences is NOT A FACT TO BE DISCOVERED but a MATTER OF CHOICE OF LANGUAGE - tolerance applied to the Circle's OWN foundations. THIS EFFECTIVELY ENDS FOUNDATIONALISM INSIDE THE CIRCLE. SCHLICK'S OBJECTION if truth is COHERENCE with the accepted system, a CONSISTENT FAIRY-TALE is as 'true' as science; coherence ALONE cannot select between rival internally consistent systems

NEURATH'S REPLY the selection is made not by LOGIC but by the ACTUAL ENCYCLOPAEDIC PRACTICE of scientists, constrained by the protocols they in fact accept

RESIDUAL this makes the choice SOCIOLOGICAL rather than EPISTEMIC. Schlick's charge is NOT FULLY MET, and Neurath accepts a NATURALISTIC consequence Schlick found unacceptable CASUALTY presupposition P2 - theory-neutral observation [15]

AFTERMATH QUINE uses the boat as the EPIGRAPH of Word and Object, 1960 - an acknowledged AFFINITY. His holism remains HIS OWN development TOPIC 11

RENDERING the boat first appears in Anti-Spengler, 1921, and a 1913 paper; renderings vary - mark it a rendering

PRINCIPLE OF TOLERANCE Logische Syntax der Sprache, 1934; English 1937, s.17

'IN LOGIC, THERE ARE NO MORALS. Everyone is at liberty to build up his own logic, i.e. his own form of language, as he wishes. All that is required of him is that, if he wishes to discuss it, he must state his methods clearly, and give SYNTACTICAL RULES INSTEAD OF PHILOSOPHICAL ARGUMENTS.'

- 1 NO single 'correct' logic or language is GIVEN by reality - only FRAMEWORKS
- 2 a framework is chosen on PRAGMATIC grounds - fruitfulness, simplicity, convenience - NOT on grounds of truth
- 3 ∴ traditional metaphysical disputes are DISGUISED PROPOSALS about which framework to adopt
- 4 ∴ intuitionist vs classical logic, phenomenalist vs physicalist language, is a CHOICE OF INSTRUMENT, not a factual disagreement

INTERNAL / EXTERNAL 'Empiricism, Semantics, and Ontology', 1950

INTERNAL 'Is there a prime number greater than 100?' asked WITHIN the arithmetical framework -> settled by MATHEMATICAL RULES AND PROOF. YES

EXTERNAL 'Are there REALLY numbers?' asked ABOUT the framework as a whole -> NOT A THEORETICAL QUESTION AT ALL. It is the PRACTICAL question whether to adopt the number-language, answered by USEFULNESS

CONSEQUENCE internal ontological questions remain LEGITIMATE; Carnap therefore DOES NOT ABOLISH EVERY USE OF ONTOLOGY. This is a STRONGER anti-metaphysics than Ayer's verdict

OBSERVATION LANGUAGE, REDUCTION AND UNITY - three programmes, three cautions

PHENOMENALIST / object talk is RECONSTRUCTED from elementary EXPERIENTIAL statements

RECONSTRUCTIONIST CAUTION risks private-language and other-minds problems

PHYSICALIST / protocols and scientific claims use an INTERSUBJECTIVELY TESTABLE

PUBLIC-LANGUAGE physical language

CAUTION Neurath and Carnap versions DIFFER; NOT simple reduction to private sensation

UNITY OF SCIENCE the sciences coordinated in a COMMON LANGUAGE or ENCYCLOPEDIA

CAUTION 'unity' may mean TRANSLATION, COORDINATION or

METHODOLOGICAL INTEGRATION - NOT one settled reduction theorem

TRAP 'the logical positivists held that all sciences reduce to physics' attributes to the school a thesis its two principal figures DISPUTED

QUINE'S BOUNDED ATTACK the internal/external distinction depends on an analytic/synthetic boundary he rejects; he favours ontology CONTINUOUS with total theory

CARNAPIAN REPLY pragmatic framework choice need NOT be a disputed analytic truth

VERDICT tolerance REFINES anti-metaphysics; Quine PRESSURES but does not by assertion

SETTLE the boundary on which that refinement depends

TOPIC 11

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 29/30: THE CRITICISM LEDGER - FOUR PRESSURES RANKED

THE FOUR PRESSURES, RANKED BY WHAT THEY ACTUALLY DID

- 1 STRONG/WEAK FORK INTERNAL, decisive. Church 1949: NO FORMULATION EVER WORKED
see panels [10] [11] [12]
- 2 PROTOCOL DEBATE INTERNAL, structural. A CHOSEN base cannot ground a criterion
advertised as a DISCOVERY about meaning [26]
- 3 ANALYTICITY + HOLISM Quine 1951: (i) analytic/synthetic cannot be non-circularly
defined -> the LINGUISTIC THEORY rests on an unclear category;
(ii) reductionism is false - statements face experience as a
CORPORATE BODY TOPIC 11
- 4 SELF-REFUTATION the principle is NEITHER analytic NOR verifiable -> meaningless
by its own standard

REPLY (i) a RECOMMENDATION about how to use 'meaningful'
COST retreats from a DISCOVERY to a POLICY; then why MUST anyone accept

REPLY (ii) ANALYTIC OF the positivists' proposed concept of meaning
COST CIRCULAR - it defines meaning so as to save itself

REPLY (iii) a META-LINGUISTIC RULE, not an object-language statement
COST still needs justification; the question RECURS at the meta-level

RESIDUE the proposal/rule reply avoids DIRECT contradiction but WEAKENS the claim
from a discovered fact about all meaning to a RECOMMENDED LINGUISTIC POLICY

CONTRASTS, NOT REPAIRS

POPPER DEMARCATION, not meaning; metaphysics MEANINGFUL; 'official opposition'

LATER WITTGENSTEIN rejects ONE essence/criterion of meaning; varied uses in
language-games; POSITIVE THEORY = TOPIC 08

ORDINARY LANGUAGE Ryle/Austin-style: commands, avowals, performatives, jokes,
mathematics and religious practices may not be FAILED EMPIRICAL REPORTS at all.

This does NOT vindicate metaphysics; it challenges the ONE-MODEL assumption

HISTORICAL END Schlick MURDERED 1936; the Circle disperses under political pressure;
members emigrate. Institutional and philosophical ends are DISTINCT

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 30/30: PYQ ROUTING, ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

PYQ ROUTING - 7 OWNED PARTS OF 112, 2018-2025; 2022 IS THE ONLY EMPTY YEAR

2018 Q3(b) 15 how shown meaningless + ALL scientific sentences? [17][18] then [25]

2019 Q2(a) 20 meaning of GENERAL statements + extension? [25] both halves

2020 Q1(e) 10 'The Soul of Superman is Good' [22] the SPLIT

2021 Q2(b) 15 pseudostatements: what + how identified + examples [17][18][19]

2023 Q3(a) 20 meaning / knowledge / nature of things? [20] then [28][29]

2024 Q3(b) 15 tautology vs observation - 'in the same way'? [24] answer NO

2025 Q3(b) 15 exposition + strong/weak [07][10][11][12]

SUPPORTING, OWNED ELSEWHERE 2019 Q1(e) 10 and 2024 Q4(c) 15 (TOPIC 11, Quine) -

2025 Q3(a) 20 (TOPIC 08, Later Wittgenstein) - boundary clauses only

ANSWER SPINE

10 MARKS state the criterion -> one FALSE-BUT-MEANINGFUL illustration -> the verdict word -> ONE qualification

15 MARKS frame (meaning NOT truth) -> exposition of BOTH halves of the biconditional -> the specific doctrine asked for -> ONE named objection with its reply -> graded verdict

20 MARKS frame -> full doctrine -> the hard cases -> at least TWO of the four pressures, ranked and with at least one INTERNAL -> the doctrine's own DEVELOPMENT (Carnap after Ayer) -> qualified conclusion

DIRECTIVES 'exposition' demands BOTH halves - 'differentiate' demands the DILEMMA, not two definitions - 'how does one identify' demands a PROCEDURE - 'critically' demands the opponent's REPLY reported before the ruling - 'all of them together' demands an ORDERING

QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

Logical positivism proposed a single test to separate what can be said from what only looks as if it were said, and the test failed in four different ways - two of them discovered by positivists themselves. It survives not as a doctrine but as a discipline: the difference-argument as a heuristic of significance, the demand for explicit rules rather than obscurity, the permanent separation of criteria of MEANING, of TRUTH and of SCIENTIFIC STATUS, and an agenda - confirmation, demarcation, holism, analyticity - that is simply the list of problems the Circle could not solve.

STATE THE ACHIEVEMENT AND ITS MATCHING COST IN THE SAME SENTENCE.